Outlook

## Re: Implementation of Revised Policy Review Cycle – Effective June 11, 2025

**From** Ward Lund, Debra L. (IHS/PHX) <Debra.Wardlund@ihs.gov>
**Date** Tue 10-Jun-25 15:36
**To** Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>; Pope, Clinton (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Clinton.Pope@ihs.gov>; Aird, Stephanie (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Stephanie.Aird@ihs.gov>; Dill, Kathy A. (IHS/PHX) <Kathy.Dill@ihs.gov>; Hixson, Naomi H. (IHS/PHX) <Naomi.Hixson@ihs.gov>; McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX) <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>; Tillman, Laura (IHS/PHX) <Laura.Tillman@ihs.gov>; Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>

Good Afternoon,

I have numerous questions and concerns and will consult with HQ before making any final policy determinations.

Thank you,

Deb

Debra Ward Lund, RN, MSN
Chief Executive Officer
Phoenix Indian Medical Center

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**From:** Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>
**Sent:** Tuesday, June 10, 2025 3:16 PM
**To:** Pope, Clinton (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Clinton.Pope@ihs.gov>; Ward Lund, Debra L. (IHS/PHX) <Debra.Wardlund@ihs.gov>; Aird, Stephanie (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Stephanie.Aird@ihs.gov>; Dill, Kathy A. (IHS/PHX) <Kathy.Dill@ihs.gov>; Hixson, Naomi H. (IHS/PHX) <Naomi.Hixson@ihs.gov>; McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX) <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>; Tillman, Laura (IHS/PHX) <Laura.Tillman@ihs.gov>; Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>
**Subject:** Re: Implementation of Revised Policy Review Cycle – Effective June 11, 2025

Mr. Pope,

I respectfully acknowledge your directive dated June 10, 2025, concerning the pause on updating policy expiration dates in PolicyStat.

I must document that this instruction conflicts with **IHS Transmittal Notice 24-16** and **IHM Part 1, Chapter 1**, which mandate biennial policy reviews and prohibit reliance on expired directives.

Compliance with these federal standards is not discretionary, and failure to reflect accurate policy review status could expose the facility to **regulatory findings**, **CMS noncompliance**, or **audit failures**.

I am obligated under HHS OIG compliance guidance and the Federal Records Act to document this variance from established requirements.

Please advise if the CEO has formally suspended application of TN 24-16 or if this directive was reviewed by the appropriate compliance/legal authorities.

Respectfully,
Kevin D. Turnage, RN
Policy Officer – PX3147
Phoenix Indian Medical Center

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Book time to meet with me

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**From:** Pope, Clinton (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Clinton.Pope@ihs.gov>
**Sent:** Tuesday, June 10, 2025 14:32
**To:** Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>; Ward Lund, Debra L. (IHS/PHX) <Debra.Wardlund@ihs.gov>; Aird, Stephanie (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Stephanie.Aird@ihs.gov>; Dill, Kathy A. (IHS/PHX) <Kathy.Dill@ihs.gov>; Hixson, Naomi H. (IHS/PHX) <Naomi.Hixson@ihs.gov>; McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX) <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>; Tillman, Laura (IHS/PHX) <Laura.Tillman@ihs.gov>; Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>
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Thank you Mr. Turnage,

I appreciate you bringing this up. We have discussed this some already amongst executive leadership and will discuss this as a leadership group to roll out a plan to comply with IHM changes and HQ directives. Do not make any changes independently regarding this. Decisions regarding this are made at the level of the CEO, per the IHM.

Very Respectfully,

**Clinton D. Pope, MSIE, CPHQ**
**Chief Quality Officer**
Indian Health Service
Department of Health and Human Services
Phoenix Service Unit

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**From:** Turnage, Kevin D. (IHS/PHX) <Kevin.Turnage@ihs.gov>
**Sent:** Tuesday, June 10, 2025 12:54 PM
**To:** Ward Lund, Debra L. (IHS/PHX) <Debra.Wardlund@ihs.gov>; Aird, Stephanie (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Stephanie.Aird@ihs.gov>; Dill, Kathy A. (IHS/PHX) <Kathy.Dill@ihs.gov>; Hixson, Naomi H. (IHS/PHX) <Naomi.Hixson@ihs.gov>; Pope, Clinton (IHS/PHX/PIMC) <Clinton.Pope@ihs.gov>; McCabe, Endreya (IHS/PHX) <Endreya.McCabe@ihs.gov>; Tillman, Laura (IHS/PHX) <Laura.Tillman@ihs.gov>; Lee, Candace S. (IHS/PHX) <Candace.Lee@ihs.gov>
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**Importance:** High

Dear Executive Leadership Team,

Please find attached a memorandum outlining the upcoming implementation of a federally mandated change to our policy review cycle, as required under **IHS Transmittal Notice 24-16** .

Effective immediately, all IHS facility directives—including PIMC policies and procedures—must undergo formal review every **two years**. Any directive exceeding that timeframe will be considered **non-compliant**. In alignment with this update, I will begin implementing necessary changes in **PolicyStat** starting **June 11, 2025**.

The attached memorandum outlines the background, compliance requirements, and the phased implementation plan. Please review and advise if there are any department-specific directives that require prioritization during this transition.

Should you have questions or require assistance initiating a review process, feel free to reach out directly.

Best regards,
**Kevin D. Turnage**
Policy Officer
Phoenix Indian Medical Center